

CANONICAL LESSON

Market Prices With Context

Decision-centred foundations for accountable sector intelligence

Production Unit	PU-B07-C12
Notebook	V7_A_N07
Status	Controlled educational draft v0.1
Data boundary	Synthetic instructional data only

Central decision: Interpret agricultural market prices with product, grade, unit, market, season, transaction context, and policy-relevant uncertainty intact.

Learning outcomes

Why this matters

Price comparisons can be false when grades, units, transaction levels, seasons, or market access conditions differ.

The analytical workflow is useful only when evidence, uncertainty, authority, and action are connected explicitly. The model supports professional judgement; it does not replace accountable institutional authority.

Worked cross-sector example

A maize price alert distinguishes wholesale from retail prices and standardizes package units before comparing markets.

Boundary: The example supports learning and review. It does not constitute an official statistic, eligibility determination, enforcement action, clinical judgement, or operational authorization.

Practice and reflection

- 1.
- Add wholesale and farmgate series without mixing levels.
- 2.
- Harmonize a 100-kg sack to kilograms.
- 3.

- Compare nominal and real alerts.
- 4.
- Explain why price weights cannot become budget shares automatically.

Answer key

- 1.
- Preserve transaction level and compare within compatible panels.
- 2.
- Divide the sack price by 100 only after validating net weight and grade.
- 3.
- Deflate with a documented index and report both interpretations.
- 4.
- Prices do not encode objectives, needs, distribution, externalities, constraints, uncertainty, or legal authority.

Operational readiness checklist

- Purpose and decision owner are named.
- Evidence definitions, provenance, and lawful access are documented.
- Uncertainty and abstention are visible.
- Human review, escalation, monitoring, incident response, and retirement are assigned.
- Equity, accessibility, security, and sector-specific approval are complete.